

arrested and imprisoned, they went on hunger strikes. The government sanctioned the feeding of Suffragette prisoners by force, but public outrage compelled them to stop this brutal practice. In another violent incident that made headlines, in 1913 Emily Wilding Davison ran into the path of the king's horse at Epsom racecourse as a form of protest and was trampled to death.

Until World War I, only four countries—New Zealand, Australia (excluding indigenous women), Finland, and Norway, as well as 11 US states—had given full voting rights to women. However, the war proved a turning point for the movement. Suffragettes supported the British war effort, and were rewarded with a concession in 1918, when property-owning women over 30 (around 40 percent of the adult female population) were given the vote. It took another decade for all women over 21 (the same as the male voting age) to become eligible.

A worldwide movement

The international connections of its leaders united the global suffrage movement. Australian Jessie Street encountered the Suffragettes while visiting relatives in England and on returning to her homeland became a lifelong champion of equal rights for women. Australia had full voting rights for women by 1908 (except indigenous women), but activists there campaigned into the 1920s for a woman's right to stand for parliament.

By the beginning of the 20th century, the US suffrage movement was organizing a program of mass demonstrations and picketing the White House, masterminded by Alice Paul. Inspired by the militancy of the British Suffragettes, Paul became a passionate and articulate advocate for votes for women. She grew dissatisfied with the National American Woman Suffrage Association (NAWSA),

◀ Disagreements among women

This illustration from French newspaper *Le Petit Journal* reinforces the idea of the volatility of female voters in its depiction of German women fighting one another at the ballot box during the municipal elections in Warburg in November 1929.

